KIEU STUDIO · GITHUB RADAR · EPISODE 31 · CHEAT SHEET

skills

Small, editable skills that teach coding agents to work like real engineers.

github.com/mattpocock/skills

+9,664	318,087	MIT
stars in 7 days · today +1,100 · Trending lists no 30-day figure	total stars · GitHub API	license · created Feb 3, 2026

Skills For Real Engineers (MIT) is the author's own daily-use set of agent skills: grilling, specs, small tickets, test first, review, a shared language. It works with Claude Code, Codex, Copilot, Gemini and many other agents; the skills are small, editable and composable.

How it works in six steps

1. **Grill before building** — /grill-with-docs
2. **Write the spec** — /to-spec
3. **Split into tickets** — /to-tickets
4. **Test first, then build** — /tdd, /implement
5. **Review on two axes** — code standards and spec
6. **Keep a shared language** — GLOSSARY.md and ADRs

Quick start

```
# Claude Code
claude plugin install mattpocock-skills@claude-plugins-official

# Codex
codex plugin marketplace add mattpocock/skills
codex plugin add mattpocock-skills@mattpocock

# Run once per repo
/setup-matt-pocock-skills

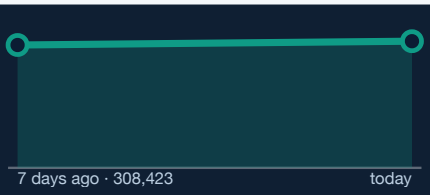
# Start a change
/grill-with-docs

# Needs: A coding agent (Claude Code, Codex, Copilot, Gemini or another); a place for tickets (GitHub, GitLab or local files)
```

Key commands / features

- **/grill-me** — grill you on non-code work
- **/grill-with-docs** — grill, update GLOSSARY.md and ADRs
- **/to-spec** — turn the conversation into a spec
- **/to-tickets** — split into small tickets with dependencies
- **/implement** — build from a spec or ticket, using /tdd

Growth



Two real points: the start of the window and today, axis from zero. The gain is as reported by GitHub Trending; we did not rebuild the star history.

Why this repo exists

- Four ways agents fail: they miss what you meant, ramble, write code that does not run, and build a ball of mud.
- Each has a cure: grilling, a shared language, test first, design discipline; you keep control.

What to use it for

- Clarify requirements before the agent writes code
- Turn a conversation into a spec and small tickets
- Force test-first and two-axis review
- Keep the project's shared language in GLOSSARY.md

Think twice before you use it

- Pick ONE install method per agent: installing both shows every skill twice.
- Run /setup-matt-pocock-skills once per repo (where tickets, labels and docs live).
- It is the author's own way of working: adapt it to your project and read the diff before merging.
- Trending lists the 7-day and today gains for this repo (no 30-day figure).

Sources: the repo's README, https://github.com/mattpocock/skills, https://aihero.dev/skills. Stars: GitHub API; gains: GitHub Trending (as reported by Trending), snapshot Nov 8, 2026; stars measure attention, not quality: re-check before relying on them. Summarized in Kieu Studio's own words; commands copied from the README; no third-party logos or screenshots.
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